Iyanuoluwa I. Taiwo

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Professional Summary

Backend Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing and building scalable, low-latency microservices and distributed systems. Expertise in API architecture, database optimization, event-driven processing, observability, and AI-powered analytics for fintech applications.

Skills

- **Languages**: Rust, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL
- **Frameworks**: Fastify, Node.js, Express, Redis, RabbitMQ, GraphQL
- **Databases**: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, TimescaleDB
- **Infrastructure**: Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD, AWS, Serverless, Linux
- **Testing**: Jest, Vitest
- **Tools**: Git, Sentry, Winston, Bull Queues, Grafana, Prometheus
- **AI & ML**: LLM APIs, Prompt Engineering, Natural-Language Interfaces, Agentic Workflows
- **Developer Tooling**: SDK & CLI Development, OpenAPI/Swagger, API Design

Experience

Backend Engineer *Oct 2024 - Present*
Taja *Lagos, NG*

- **Abuse Detection**: Implemented device fingerprinting and abuse-detection controls to identify impersonation attempts, reducing account takeover incidents by 30%.
- **Query & Database Design**: Optimized SQL queries, database indexes, and schema design to cut average request latency by 20% while improving data integrity across core fintech features.
- **Third-Party Integrations**: Integrated external APIs for payments and identity verification, building provider-agnostic abstraction with automatic failover that routes requests to backup providers when any single service fails, ensuring uninterrupted uptime.
- **Admin Dashboard**: Developed an admin dashboard for internal operations workflows, helping increase organizational productivity by 50% through faster task handling and reporting.

Software Engineer (contract) *Oct 2025 - May 2026*
Kite *Lagos, NG*

- **Unified API Layer**: Architected a unified API layer around major payment providers, consolidating complex financial rails into a single high-performance interface used by multiple client applications, instrumented with centralized logging, monitoring, and end-to-end observability.
- **Team Leadership**: Led a team of 2 engineers, defining the technical roadmap, code-review standards, and quarterly planning process while maintaining 99.9% system uptime.
- **Regression Testing**: Introduced automated unit and integration regression testing (Jest) across critical payment flows, cutting production bug escapes by over 50% in the first quarter.
- **Event-Driven Processing**: Implemented event-driven background processing via RabbitMQ consumers and Bull queues for async email delivery, virtual account creation, and scheduled exchange rate updates.

Software Engineer *May 2023 - Nov 2024*
LocalRamp *Lagos, NG*

- **Fiat-to-Crypto Gateway**: Led end-to-end development of a fiat-to-crypto gateway processing millions in monthly transaction volume, with PCI-DSS compliance and KYC/AML integration.
- **Analytics Dashboard**: Built a real-time analytics dashboard for operations teams and an embeddable widget adopted by 300+ enterprise clients, contributing to an 18% improvement in retention.
- **CI/CD Optimization**: Reduced CI/CD pipeline duration by 70% by streamlining build and deployment stages, and authored API design standards that cut new engineer onboarding time by 40%.

Backend Engineer / Full Stack Developer *Jan 2022 - Nov 2024*
payouts.cash *Lagos, NG*

- **Payment APIs**: Designed and implemented backend services for the 2022 payouts.cash platform to facilitate Naira - crypto conversions, payment links, and order management.
- **Transactions & Webhooks**: Built transaction models, webhook handlers, and idempotent payment flows to safely process buy/sell orders and payout callbacks.
- **Integrations**: Integrated with banking/crypto rails and exchange rate sources, with validation and failure handling for unreliable external providers.
- **Operational Readiness**: Implemented logging, transaction tracing, and admin/support tooling to assist with investigations, reconciliation, and reliable transaction processing.

Projects

RateLimitr (TypeScript, Fastify, Redis, TimescaleDB) *2024*

- Distributed multi-tenant rate-limiting service handling 10,000+ RPS across 50+ nodes using atomic Redis Lua operations, with real-time analytics via TimescaleDB and an LLM-powered analytics assistant that answers tenant questions in plain English.

Synapse (TypeScript, Express, MongoDB, Redis) *2025*

- Multi-tenant payment API unifying 3 providers behind a single adapter interface — virtual accounts, cards, KYC/KYB, and cross-border payouts across 6+ financial services. Secured with JWT/API-key auth, rate limiting, structured logging, and Sentry.

Education

Alex Ekwuememe Federal University, Ebonyi State, Abakaliki Ebonyi, Nigeria
Bachelor of Science - Computer Science; GPA: 3.5

- **Courses**: Operating Systems, Data Structures, Analysis Of Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Networking, Databases

Certifications

- **HackerRank**: Software Engineer • Oct 2026 • Credential ID: AE666AC16F1C • verify